

Exclamation points

EXCLAMATION POINTS ARE USED AT THE END OF EXCLAMATIONS.

An exclamation point indicates the end of an exclamation, which is a sentence that expresses a writer's strong emotions. It can also be used for emphasis.

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Emotions

The exclamation point is used at the end of an exclamation to express a strong emotion, such as surprise, excitement, or anger, or a raised voice.

This is so unexpected!



Surprise!

I love cheese!



Fear!

I'm allergic to cheese!



Excitement!

Stop nibbling on the cheese!



Anger!

• Use exclamation points **sparingly** in **formal writing**. They rarely improve a piece of writing.

• If it is unclear whether or not an exclamation point is needed, remember that it is **usually preferable to end a statement with a period**.

GLOSSARY

Exclamation A sentence expressing a strong emotion, such as surprise, or a raised voice.

Interjection A word or phrase that occurs alone and expresses emotion.

Question A sentence that asks for information.

REAL WORLD

Comics

Exclamation points are a feature of comic books. Some comics use them in almost every sentence. An exclamation point can also be part of an illustration, used on its own next to a character's head to indicate surprise, or with interjections representing sounds, such as *Pow!* or *Zap!* In the 1950s, the exclamation point was called a "bang." This may be because the exclamation point often appeared on its own in a speech bubble next to the barrel of a gun to show that it had just been fired.

